



Kaizen Application Theory

To make a copy of this document click [here](#) then go to File → Make A Copy

Introduction

This resource explains the fundamentals behind **Kaizen**, continuous improvement, and how it relates to landing a software engineering job.

Kaizen and Forging 🔥

"Do not wait to strike till the iron is hot; but make it hot by striking."

– William Butler Yeats.

Kaizen is a Japanese philosophy that means "continuous improvement". It focuses on making **small, incremental changes** to processes over time to achieve significant improvements.

It also emphasizes the importance of **setting new standards** after improvements are made.

1. *Improve Constantly*
2. *Raise The Bar*
3. *Repeat*

Kaizen made Toyota one of the **most powerful** and efficient car manufacturers **in the world**.

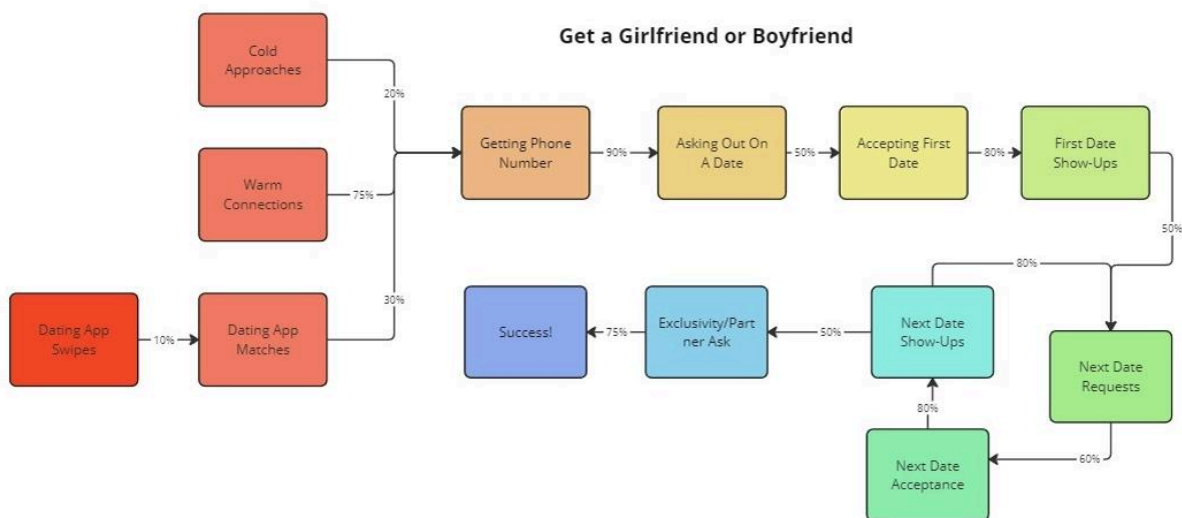
The Art of Landing a Job 📁

Every outcome or result in life is downstream of a system or **chain of events**.

You can boil almost everything into a series of steps that are connected together with **inputs, outputs, and probabilities**.

AM

Dating:



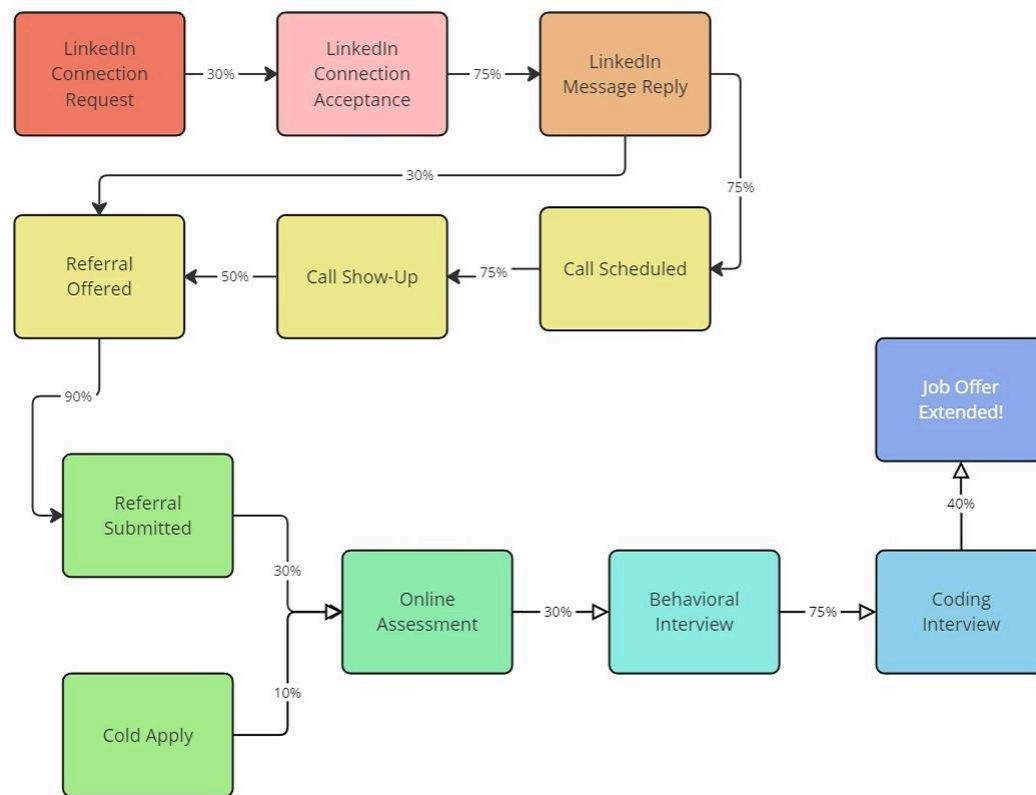
Cold Approaches: 100

Warm Connections: 50

Dating App Swipes: 200

Total Success: Approximately **1.8565** successful partnerships.

Software Engineering Job Acquisition:



LinkedIn Connection Requests needed: Approximately 312

Cold Applications needed: Approximately 112

In this game, nothing is a given. Every single individual event is a probability and **cannot be treated with certainty**.

Vocabulary:

Inputs: Cold Applications + LinkedIn Connection Requests

Outputs: Rejection/Offer + Feedback

Rejections: When an applicant is informed that they will not be moving forward in the hiring process or will not be offered the job they applied for.

Offers: A formal proposal of employment made by an employer to a candidate.

Feedback: The insights you receive about your performance in the interview process, helping you understand the reasons for a rejection or offer and how to improve.

Process Improvement: The act of improving the conversion rates between each step of the job application and interview system.

You can receive output at any part of the process as well as at the end.

To land a software engineering job offer, you simply must **push enough inputs** into the system and wait until you finally receive a positive output.

The Fundamental Mistake 🌱

The Garden Hose Problem



Job Application Process = A Garden Hose.

Watering A Plant = Landing A Job Offer

You notice that no water is coming out and hitting the plants, so you keep increasing the faucet and water pressure – yet still, no water is coming out. *None at all.*



- In reality, your garden hose has tons and tons of leaks everywhere – so the water is going everywhere **except** where you want it to go.
- Instead of piping more water into the hose, **focus on fixing the leaks.**
- Even though many of you have submitted over **100 applications**, this is why you still struggle with landing a job.

Flip Your Focus ⌚

Most people spend **90% of effort on pumping in inputs** and only **10% on process improvements**.

You need to flip your focus – **spend 90% of your time on fixing leaks** and **10% pumping in inputs**.



Your Quest

How to Win

1. Watch All Modules in the Accelerator and Immediately Plug as Many Leaks as Possible as You Go
2. Pipe in 50-100 Inputs (Applications + Connection Requests)
3. Generate Results and Feedback
4. Use Feedback + Accelerator Coaching Calls to Improve Your Process
5. Repeat Steps 2 - 4
6. Land a Software Engineering Job or Internship

The Power of Feedback: My Experience With Fetch and Shopify

How to Lose

1. Don't Use Feedback to Improve Your Process
2. Give Up and Stop Inputs in the System

The best way to lose in this game is to give up, to feel like it's hopeless, and that no matter how much time, effort and iteration you put in you'll never find a job.

The best way to achieve hopelessness is to believe that the game is rigged and that you can't win because it's **out of your control**.

Locus of Control

External: Success is determined by factors out of your control, like luck, your environment, and the market. Effectively, these people believe that all they have to do is wait until the market "recovers" and then they'll just be handed a job.

Internal: You believe you control your own destiny through your actions, efforts, and abilities. So effectively, instead of a software engineering job finding you, you believe that you are the one who can and will go out there and get that job, no matter how "tough" the market is.

REPLACE "THE MARKET IS BAD" with "I'M BAD, AND I'M GOING TO GET BETTER"

If you're getting offended right now, pay attention to that feeling.

Don't wait until the market 'gets better', make the market better by getting so good it doesn't matter.

How to Improve 💪

1. Implement All Systems in the Accelerator

Watch every video, in order, and do every single thing I say.

2. Determine Your Bottleneck

A bottleneck is your limiting step, the thing that's holding everything back.

Resume / LinkedIn / Referrals / Behavioral Interviews / Coding Interviews / LeetCode

3. Ruthlessly Improve Your Weakness

Use homework, mock interviews, assignments given in the Accelerator to improve your bottleneck until it's no longer the biggest issue.

4. Find Another Bottleneck

Resume / LinkedIn / Referrals / Behavioral Interviews / Coding Interviews / LeetCode

5. Repeat!

Don't Focus On What You're Already Good At



Duct-Taping Hose Analogy / People Tend to Hyper-Fixate on What They're Already Good At (Because It's Comfortable)

Bottleneck Analysis & Theory of Constraints

Why Some Systems Break – and How to Fix Them

Even after implementing every system in the Accelerator, many students still find themselves stuck. Maybe you're applying like crazy, you've built your Resume + LinkedIn, and even landing interviews – but offers just aren't coming. What's going wrong?

Enter: *Theory of Constraints*.

What is the Theory of Constraints?

The **Theory of Constraints** (TOC) is a process improvement philosophy from manufacturing and operations that applies perfectly to your job search.

The idea is simple:

Your results are limited by the weakest link (your constraint). Fix that, and your entire system improves.

Just like a factory's output is limited by the slowest machine, your job hunt is limited by the step in your funnel that's underperforming — even if everything else is solid.

The Bottleneck Principle

A **bottleneck** is the step that slows down everything else.

If you don't fix it, no matter how much effort you put in elsewhere, you're stuck.

Example:

- Submitting 100+ applications...
- But your resume is still not great - thus leaking opportunities like a garden hose full of holes...
- Which means you'll never land interviews — no matter how many you submit.

Identifying the bottleneck = your #1 job as a job-seeker.



How to Solve Your Own Problems 🧠

When the system “isn’t working,” (4-6 months of consistent effort doing everything we say, yet still no offer) this is your roadmap:

1. Step Back

Stop spamming. Stop guessing. Breathe. Your job is now to analyze, not act.

2. Diagnose the Bottleneck

Your funnel has 5 stages:

- *Number of Applications*
- *Number of LinkedIn Connection Requests*
- *Number of Referrals*
- *Interviews (Online Assessments, Behavioral + Technical)*
- *Offers*

3. Bring the Data

On our coaching calls, we don’t guess – we diagnose. So bring this breakdown (ideally in a chart/table):

Step	Results	Comments / Feedback
Applications Submitted	100+	Getting ~3% response rate
Referrals	4 – all cold DMs, no warm intros	1 led to a recruiter screen
Behavioral Interviews	2 – dropped after first round	No feedback given
Technical Interviews	1 – OA failed	Wasn’t confident in DP / Recursion
Feedback / Patterns	Rejections seem to come after OA	Resume gets ghosted most of the time

1. What To Do When You're Stuck:

"Can you please break down all your results? That way I can see exactly where things might be going wrong. Please include:

- ✓ All applications you submitted
- ✓ Any referrals you got (and who gave them)
- ✓ Interviews you landed – each round, which round you didn't pass
- ✓ Whether it was technical, behavioral, or an online assessment (OA)
- ✓ Any feedback you got, or patterns you noticed"

2. We'll Identify the Bottleneck Together

*You bring the chart → I tell you what's not working and why.
Then, you go fix that – ruthlessly – until it's no longer your constraint.*

Systems Don't Fail – They Reveal the Bottleneck

If you're using every system in this course and still not seeing results, it's not that the system is broken.

It means one part of the system is your constraint

Your job: find it and fix it.

Recap: What to Do When You're Stuck

1. Create your results chart
2. Identify your current constraint
3. Ask for coaching help if needed
4. Apply focused effort to that constraint
5. Repeat once the constraint shifts